(10/23)

There have been multiple positive developments in the progress of this project this week. For one, on the 22nd I met with a group of a half-dozen or so older adults at Valley Village who showed some immediate interest in my project, and my help sessions. I spoke to them, introduced myself, my goals, and how I hope that we could mutually help each other: I could speak to their issues and frustrations with technology, and they could provide me with some qualitative research in the process. They were incredibly receptive, and I am excited to be spending some time there throughout the coming weeks, working with them and understanding this community's relationship with technology.

Additionally, I was contacted about an opportunity at the local Townshend library, who plan on hosting a "Tech Hour," where they hoped to provide their patrons with programming surrounding tech skills and a conversation about artificial intelligence. I plan on helping them facilitate these conversations, and designing some of their programming as a part of my capstone. This has created another facet of community outreach and understanding, and I am excited to see how my relationship with them is established and grows with this project.

I have been spending time working on synthesizing some of my research into fields of thought, the themes and gaps within them, and ones shared between them. Generally, I have separated fields of thought in my research into:

Barriers of adoption

Caregivers, informal and formal

Device / Use

Local

Privacy & Trust

Some emergent ideas and themes that I have distinguished that are relevant to all of these ideas within the gerontechnology tech adoption space were:

> **Technology adoption as a "social process,** even more than a technical one" (Yusif 2016). Social contexts are incredibly important to understand in this project, and should be an increased measure of thought and reflection as I continue to interact with these different and unique communities in my local area.

Individuality & Individualization: understanding technology struggles exist through the ways technology wants to and needs to be used. With individualized issues, I need to incorporate individualized solutions. Moreover, design decisions often diminish individuality, which can negatively impact unfamiliar users. These ideas need to be taken into account for my designing decisions and processing the data from my qualitative research

Awareness, whether it be of risks, opportunities, tools, possibilities, or problems, is something that is incredibly important, and especially lacking throughout this field.

Participatory codesign and **inclusive** and **aware design decisions** are also an emergent theme that I have deemed important to the ethos of this project. As an interdisciplinary study, my goals align with understanding through mutual learning, and creating opportunities for my target audience to be a part of the design process, so they can tackle their unique issues, within their unique contexts of use.

Intrusivity. Technology as a product is inherently intrusive as a symptom of existing within a capitalist schema. As the outsider, attempting to understand people's struggle with technology, and how I can potentially facilitate it with my own tools and skills, my role could very easily become an intrusive one. Care, consideration, and awareness of my interactions with the local community, and addressing realized and vocalized issues is a priority. Moreover, I want to create solutions that won't be intrusive to institutional organizers, nor participants/residents. To stress the importance of this, my goals are to be as informative as I am helpful, and provide solutions that are clear, useful, and are understood by all involved parties.

In the following weeks, my literature review will be drafted and written. It will address my goals for my research, concepts and language, the state of the research, and its characterization, and how I plan on using it in the continuation of this capstone project. Additionally, within the next week or so, I hope to create and give out the surveys that I had previously mentioned development of.